TrustFit PRD (hackathon build)

Oct 24, 2026 · @Harjodh

Overview and problem

For the hackathon we build the Trust layer of TrustFit as a working web app: an analyst enters verified evidence about an Indian company, and a Japanese SME gets a 0–100 Trust Score, a confidence level and a Green, Amber or Red verdict for one role (supplier, distributor or JV partner). Fit screening is specified here but built after the hackathon.

The problem. JETRO-PS-01 asks how Japanese SMEs can enter and expand in India more effectively and efficiently. TrustFit targets two of its six asks: identifying, evaluating and verifying reliable local partners, and building trustworthy long-term partnerships.

Why it matters. The figures in our pitch deck:

- 61.8% of responding Japanese manufacturers named India a promising market for the next 3 years, No. 1 for a 4th year (JBIC FY2025 survey, 209 of 338).
- 35.1% of Japanese firms not planning an overseas base rely on agents and partners instead, the top reason (JETRO FY2025 survey, n=998).
- 85.2% of surveyed firms are short of staff for overseas business (JETRO FY2025 survey, n=3,063).
- Impact HD booked about ¥1.93bn in 2019 on its Indian JV with Coffee Day Global (TSE filing, 26 Jan 2023).

Product principles

1. Trust decides eligibility; Fit justifies the visit.
2. Only verified evidence counts. Missing data lowers confidence, never the score.
3. A strong area can't hide a weak one: the weakest-link rule and the overrides protect the verdict.
4. Show categories and weights; keep parameter rubrics confidential so companies can't game the score.
5. Call it a "score", never a "rating": SEBI regulates credit rating agencies.

Scoring rules source of truth: TrustFit scoring rules and overrides (v1).

Goals and non-goals

The hackathon build succeeds if a judge watches Subros get scored live and the numbers match the pitch deck exactly.

Goals

1. Score a company end to end in the app: evidence in, Trust Score, confidence, verdict and outlook out.
2. Reproduce the Subros result from the deck: 87 (Very strong), 62% of points verified, Amber because Integrity is only 32.5% verified, outlook Watch.
3. Show the score change live: switch the role, or mark the pending integrity checks as clean and watch the verdict turn Green.
4. Give the SME a one-page report it can read and export as a PDF.
5. Keep the engine deterministic and versioned, so every score can be explained and re-run.

Non-goals for the hackathon

- The Fit engine and the SME brief (specified in Future scope only).
- Automated scraping of paid or login-only sources.
- SME self-sign-up, billing or a public company directory.
- Ongoing monitoring and alerts.
- Data uploaded by the scored companies themselves (consented tier T3).

Users and use cases

The MVP has two hands-on users: an analyst who builds the score, and the SME who reads it.

Persona	Who	What they need	MVP access
SME decision-maker	Overseas-business lead at a Japanese SME	A clear verdict, the reasons behind it, and what is still unchecked	Read reports, switch role, export PDF
TrustFit analyst	Our team member doing the checks	Fast evidence entry, source tracking, instant re-scoring	Create companies, enter evidence and flags, run scores

Persona	Who	What they need	MVP access
Admin	Our team lead	Control over weights and rubric versions	Edit weight sets, see full rubrics
Indian company (later)	The company being scored	A way to add consented data and correct errors	None in MVP

Use cases

1. **Score a company for a role.** The analyst enters evidence for the 37 parameters and the app returns score, confidence, verdict and outlook.
2. **See why a verdict is Amber.** The SME sees which dimension is under-verified and which checks are pending.
3. **Compare roles.** The same company is scored as supplier, distributor and JV partner side by side.
4. **Run a what-if.** The analyst marks pending checks as clean, or adds a red flag, and sees the new verdict before saving.
5. **Export the report.** The SME downloads a one-page PDF to share internally.
6. **Catch stale evidence.** The app flags evidence past its freshness limit and drops it from the score.

MVP scope

Build every P0 item first. Pick up P1 only once the P0 demo path works end to end; P2 is stretch.

Priority	Feature	What it does
P0	Company profile	Name, CIN, listing (NSE/BSE codes), sector, role being assessed
P0	Evidence entry	One row per parameter: level (0, 25, 50, 75 or 100%), verified yes/no, source link, source date, checked date, data tier (T1 public, T2 peer, T3 company)
P0	Red-flag entry	Record knock-outs, caps and notches, each with its evidence

Priority	Feature	What it does
P0	Scoring engine	Role weights, category and dimension scores, confidence, overrides, weakest-link rule, band and verdict
P0	Score report	Big score, band, confidence, 8 category bars with verified points, dimensions, overrides applied, verdict and the reason for it
P0	Subros seed data	Subros loaded so the demo matches the deck exactly
P1	Role switcher	Recompute instantly for supplier, distributor or JV partner
P1	What-if mode	Mark pending checks as clean, or add a flag, and preview the new verdict without saving
P1	Outlook	Five trend signals produce Positive, Stable or Watch
P1	Freshness rules	Evidence older than 24 months, or registry, court and GST checks older than 30 days, drop out of the score and are flagged
P1	PDF export	One-page SME report
P1	Login with roles	Analyst, admin and viewer access
P2	Auto-fetch helpers	Pull free, public data such as sanctions lists to pre-fill evidence for analyst review
P2	Japanese report	The SME report in Japanese
P2	Score history	Every run saved with its weight version, with a change log
P2	Peer comparison	Two or three companies side by side for one role

Product rules

The app implements the founder scoring system (v1) exactly; the full rubric for each parameter lives in the scoring rules doc.

Structure. 37 parameters sit in 8 categories and 3 dimensions: Integrity (A Legal & regulatory, C Governance), Financial (B Financial health, E Payment conduct) and Capability (D Reputation, F Operations, G Cross-border, H ESG).

Role weights (points out of 100)

Role	A	C	B	E	D	F	G	H
Supplier	15	15	20	10	10	20	5	5
Distributor	15	10	20	20	15	10	5	5
JV partner	15	25	25	5	5	10	10	5

Parameter splits (% of the category's points)

Category	Splits
A	A1 10 · A2 20 · A3 25 · A4 35 · A5 10
B	B1 15 · B2 15 · B3 15 · B4 20 · B5 20 · B6 10 · B7 5
C	C1 35 · C2 20 · C3 15 · C4 20 · C5 10
D	D1 25 · D2 30 · D3 20 · D4 20 · D5 5
E	E1 40 · E2 30 · E3 20 · E4 10
F	F1 15 · F2 15 · F3 30 · F4 15 · F5 25 (distributor: F3 10 · F4 50 · F5 10)
G	G1 35 · G2 30 · G3 20 · G4 15
H	H1 70 · H2 30

Scoring

- Each parameter scores 0, 25, 50, 75 or 100% of its points, and only if its evidence is verified and fresh.
- Freshness: evidence is at most 24 months old; registry, court and GST checks at most 30 days.
- Score = points earned ÷ points verified × 100. Confidence = points verified (out of 100).
- Dimension scores and dimension confidence use the same formula within each dimension.

Overrides

- Knock-outs (not eligible, no score): registration struck off, cancelled or dormant; confirmed sanctions match; insolvency admitted; wilful-defaulter or disqualified director; fraud finding.
- Caps: adverse or disclaimer audit opinion → 50; going-concern uncertainty → 60; tax or enforcement asset attachment in the last 24 months → 65.
- Fake reviews: D1 is excluded and the verdict is Amber at best.
- Notches, net total within ±8: one customer over 70% of revenue −3; promoter-group company in default −5; strong OEM, tier-1 or MNC shareholder at 10% or more +3.

```
\text{Final} = \min(\text{Score} + \text{Notches},\ \text{Weakest dimension}
+ 15,\ \text{Cap})
```

Bands: 85–100 Very strong · 70–84 Strong · 55–69 Adequate · 40–54 Weak · 0–39 Very weak.

Confidence: below 40% means no score. Below 60% overall, or below 50% in any dimension, makes the result provisional.

Verdict, checked in this order

1. Knock-out or failed gate → Red (not eligible).
2. Final score below 55 → Red.
3. Provisional, score 55–69, gate pending or fake-review flag → Amber.
4. Otherwise → Green (score 70 or more).

When Fit launches it adds two checks: Fit below 50 → Red; Fit 50–69 → Amber.

Outlook: five trend signals, each improving, stable or worsening. Three or more improving → Positive; three or more worsening → Watch; otherwise Stable. Outlook is shown beside the verdict and does not change it.

User flows and screens

Two straight-line flows cover the MVP: the analyst builds the score, the SME reads it.

Analyst flow

1. Create the company: name, CIN, listing codes, sector.
2. Pick the role to assess (supplier, distributor or JV partner).

3. Work through the evidence grid, category by category: set each parameter's level, tick verified, add the source link and dates.
4. Record any red flags: knock-outs, caps, notches.
5. Enter the five trend signals for the outlook.
6. Press Score: the panel shows score, confidence, verdict and the reason for it.
7. Optionally run a what-if, then publish the report.

SME flow

1. Open the report link.
2. Read the verdict, score, band and confidence at the top.
3. Check the category bars and see which areas are under-verified.
4. Read "What turns it Green": the checks still to run.
5. Switch role if needed, then export the PDF.

Screens

Screen	Who	Key elements
Company list	Analyst	Search, latest score and verdict chip per company, "New company"
Company setup	Analyst	Profile form, role picker
Evidence grid	Analyst	37 rows grouped A–H; level picker; verified tick; source link; dates; tier; stale warning
Flags and trends	Analyst	Knock-out, cap and notch pickers with evidence; five trend signals
Score panel	Analyst	Live score, confidence, dimension scores, overrides applied, what-if toggle
SME report	SME	Verdict banner, big score, band, confidence, 8 category bars with verified points, overrides, outlook, "What turns it Green", PDF button
Weights admin	Admin	Weight-set versions per role, parameter splits, publish a new version

The SME report shows categories and weights only, never parameter rubrics, in line with the disclosure plan.

Demo plan and acceptance criteria

The live demo is a three-minute walk through Subros that ends with the verdict turning Green on screen.

Demo script

1. Open Subros, already seeded, as a supplier: 87, Very strong, Amber.
2. Point at the pale category bars: legal, governance, reputation and payment conduct are under half verified.
3. Show the reason: Integrity only 32.5% verified, under the 50% minimum.
4. Switch to what-if and mark the six pending integrity checks (A1, A3, A4, A5, C1, C2) as clean: confidence goes to 82.5%, score to 90, verdict Green.
5. Add a test knock-out, such as a sanctions match: the verdict drops to Red, not eligible.
6. Switch the role to JV partner and show the weights and score change.
7. Export the PDF report.

Acceptance criteria

- [ ] Subros as supplier returns verified 62.25, earned 54.25, score 87, band Very strong.
- [ ] Dimension scores: Integrity 83 (32.5% verified), Financial 85 (76.7%), Capability 90 (73.75%).
- [ ] Notches +3 and −3 net to 0; weakest-link limit 98 does not bind; final 87.
- [ ] Verdict Amber with reason "Integrity under 50% verified"; outlook Watch.
- [ ] What-if with the six integrity checks clean returns confidence 82.5, score 90, Green.
- [ ] Any knock-out returns Red, not eligible, with no score shown.
- [ ] A cap lowers the final score to the cap, for example 80 → 50 after an adverse audit opinion.
- [ ] Confidence below 40% returns "no score".
- [ ] Changing the role recomputes in under 1 second.
- [ ] The PDF matches the on-screen report.

Success measures for the hackathon

- At least 3 companies scored (Subros plus two others).
- Every engine test passes, including the Subros fixture.
- The demo runs offline from seeded data if the network fails.

Future scope

Fit is the next product: it screens trusted companies against one SME's brief and sorts them into categories that differ from SME to SME.

Fit screening (phase 2)

- **SME brief in:** six factors, weighted by what the SME needs: sector and product experience (FT1), regional coverage (FT2), sales and distribution channels (FT3), capacity vs requirement (FT4), after-sales and service (FT5), competing-brand conflict (FT6, scored inversely).
- **Categories out:** Strong fit (shortlist), Possible fit (gaps to close), Not a fit (skip, even if trusted).
- **Rule:** Fit can lower a verdict but never raise it. Trust still decides eligibility.
- **Example:** Subros, 20% owned by Denso, could be a strong fit for an SME entering Maruti's supply chain, but not for a Denso rival. Same Trust Score, different Fit.
- **Starting weights:** v1.0 used FT1 25, FT2 20, FT3 20, FT4 15, FT5 10, FT6 10; the brief adjusts these per SME.

After Fit

1. A 20-company pilot, then a backtest against companies with known failures to calibrate weights.
2. Consented company data (tier T3) and a way for companies to correct errors.
3. Monitoring: re-score when filings, ratings or court records change, and alert the SME.
4. A Japanese-language interface and partnerships with JETRO offices or trade bodies.

Risks, legal and disclosure

The biggest risks are being mistaken for a credit rating agency and publishing a wrong claim about a real company; both are handled by wording, evidence and review.

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Seen as a credit rating	SEBI regulates credit rating agencies	Always say "score", never "rating"; state that it is not a credit rating or investment advice

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Wrong or unfair claim about a company	Reputation and defamation risk	Verified sources only, every value linked to its source, analyst review before publishing, a correction route for companies
Companies gaming the score	Scores lose meaning	Show categories and weights only; keep rubric cut-offs and fraud rules confidential
Personal data of directors	India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023	Store only what a check needs, for that purpose; no personal data in the SME report
Scraping terms of service	Access blocked or legal notice	MVP enters data by hand from public pages; automate only open, permitted sources
Stale evidence	Score no longer true	Freshness rules drop old evidence automatically and flag it
Live demo fails	Lost pitch moment	Seeded data, local build and a recorded backup video

Not legal advice: confirm the SEBI and data-protection points with a lawyer before any public launch.

Open questions

- [ ] How long is the hackathon build window, and how many people are on the team?
- [ ] Which two companies do we score besides Subros (ideally one strong and one with a red flag)?
- [ ] Which five trend signals make up the outlook (proposed: revenue growth, operating margin, operating cash flow, cash conversion cycle, latest credit rating action)?
- [ ] What are verification gates V1–V3 checking in v1, and who marks them passed?
- [ ] Do judges get the confidential rubric annex on request, and under what terms?
- [ ] Is a Japanese-language report worth pulling into the hackathon scope?